

GT OSPO VSIP Mentorship Training

Updated March 2026



Georgia Tech
Open Source Program Office

**Georgia Tech's Open Source Program Office (OSPO)
aims to build open-source capacity on campus and at
nearby academic institutions through education on
best practices, outreach, and training and engagement
of students.**



OSPO@GT Core Objectives – 2025 - 2027

OSPO Goal 1: Support GT OSPO Sustainability

Improve OSS Developer Engagement

Create a welcoming community for all developers and engage in robust community outreach

Develop added metrics to track OSPO progress and criteria for success

Support Developers at GT and other Atlanta universities through workshops, training sessions, and meet-ups

Institutionalize Student Programs

Evolve the virtual summer internship program to be more sustainable and allow for more opportunity for all interested students

Enhance and Improve training materials to allow for more large-scale, asynchronous OSS training programs

Address the AI Revolution

Educate students on the benefits and pitfalls of open-source AI and current viewpoints, including the ethical use of AI

Host Open Data Sets and exploration tools for AI data agents

Provide training for AI hardware and software tools on local HPC resources

Design joint software engineering training with other GT groups

Explore GT Strengths in OSS

Collaborate with Georgia Tech's School of Cybersecurity and GTRI to develop and share secure open-source best practices.

Support institute efforts in maintaining research integrity using open-source techniques

OSPO Goal 2: Support a Sustainable OSS Community for GT and Atlanta

OSPPO Virtual Internship Program Details



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OSPO Virtual Internship Program

10 week program, starting in May and running through July

Students apply and are selected by OSPO team and paired with an OSS project

- OSPO can fund undergrad/grad student work up to 20 hours per week for up to 25-30 students
- Projects usually are mapped with 1-2 undergrads and 1 grad student
- OSPO will help to drive the initial student selection process and mapping to teams

Program consists of close interactions with mentors on project team and weekly seminars to share open-source concepts

- Milestones for reporting of interactions with students along with a virtual poster session at the end of the internship
- Modules focused on developing core skills to enable students to **contribute to open source projects** and **initiate their own open source projects**
- Discord group allows for asynchronous interactions with mentors and students

Virtual Internship Program – Timeline (1 of 2)

Date	Activity	Notes
Feb - March	Mentors recruited; target projects selected	
March 17th	Mentor lightning talks, student application opens	
1 st week of April	Students notified of acceptance	
May 18 th	Virtual Internship program officially begins	
(Week of) May 25 th	Submission of official milestones for students	Mentors and students meet and discuss projects and set milestones
May 19 th	OSS Module 1 – Review Git Best Practices	All modules are virtual workshops with slides / hands-on
May 26 th	OSS Module 2 – Contributing to OSS	Work through PRs, issue tracking
June 2 rd	OSS Module 3 – Testing your Code	Discuss CI/CD and basic testing
June 9 th	OSS Module 4 – Code Reviews	Learn how to review PRs and team communication

Virtual Internship Program – Timeline (2 of 2)

Date	Activity	Notes
(Week of) June 15 th	Milestone 1 – Midterm Check-in	Discuss any sticking points with teams
June 23 rd	OSS Module 5 – OSS Tips and Tricks	Talk about lessons learned from existing OSS communities
June 30 th	OSS Module 6 – Building OSS Community	
July 7 th	Milestone 2 – Midterm Check-in	
July 14 th	Finalize OSS Contributions	Work on cleaning up and code/documentation contributions
July 23 nd	Final Poster Presentations	

Mentorship



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Virtual Internship Program – Why Join as a Mentor?

Mentoring students for this program is anticipated to take a few hours per week

- Ideally, 1-2 hours of standalone meetings along with asynchronous meetings and interactions
- Estimate 3-4 hours per week contribution; students work 20 hours per week

But why?

Talent development

- Mentoring students can help to develop students with the skill sets and interests for future IBM internships or employment.

Growth of the Community

- Additional contributors to your OSS project from students can help to identify missing features and documentation that are useful for project growth and sustainability.
- Using this program can help you better understand aspects of how to support a wider **community** that includes users with interest and differing skill sets!

Personal Development and Leadership

- Make yourself more marketable within your organization

Mentorship Basics

Existing programs like Google's Summer of Code (GSoC) can provide a template for mentors in this program.

The VSIP has a few differences from GSoC. However, there are commonalities:

- Mentors contribute time to work with students and develop project ideas and goals
- Mentors follow guidelines of the program for communication and collaboration with students
- Mentors work with the OSPO directors and IBM collaborators to resolve any problems encountered according to our Code of Conduct
- We anticipate having **at least** one internal mentor (to help handle GT processes) and one external mentor per project



Google Summer of Code

<https://developers.google.com/open-source/gsoc/resources/mentors>

Project Idea List and Advertising

Each project idea must contain

- i. A project title and brief description (2-5 sentences)
- ii. Goal of the summer project and expected outcomes
- iii. Skills required/preferred
 - i. If possible, provide a rating of how easy/hard the project might be for newcomers

We suggest looking at previous examples as a template for advertising projects

- OSPo team members will then help to match students with appropriate projects

Project Ideas Due for Student Information Session March 17th

Project Slide Ideas – Examples from earlier VSIPs

We suggest a 3 slide template for each project

1. What the project is about

- maintainers and the Github / URL for the project

2) Project Ideas

- Ideally mapped to different skill levels

3) Contact Information

How to Get Involved?



More Information and Links

Join the Mailing List

Introduce yourself, read discussions.

Report Issues, Improve Docs

Easy first steps to contribute.

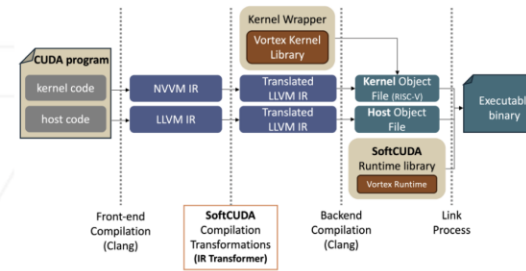
Submit Pull Requests

Fix bugs, add features, engage with committers.

Participate in Community Discussions – Apache projects value collaborative decision-making.

Earn Committer Status through sustained contributions.

SoftCUDA: Execute CUDA on Vortex



Vortex binary generation steps using SoftCUDA

Key insights

- **First Framework** to support CUDA on softGPU.
- Flat-collapsing applied to map CUDA threads and Vortex HW thread.
- Kernel_wrapper for kernel invocation on Vortex using Vortex Kernel Library.

Candidate Granite and/or Open Source AI Projects

- [Create Prepared Meals](#) |
- [Create Recipes for Granite, Time Series, Guardian](#) |
- Create a Granite Time Series Workshop similar to the [current Granite Workshop](#) |
- Explore Granite integration with [Adversarial Robustness Toolbox](#) (Security and Safety) |
- [Add more functionality to the Model Openness Tool MOT](#) from the Linux Foundation AI and Data

Many more Granite related projects are possible

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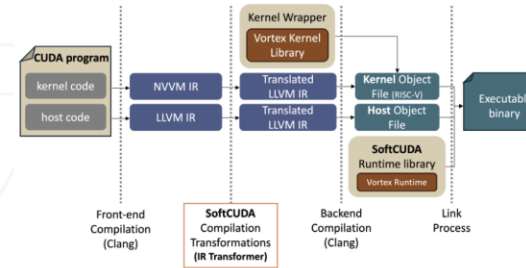
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See mentor slide examples from last year at https://github.com/gt-ospo/summer-internship-program/blob/main/2025/information_session_agenda.md

Project Ideas – Examples from RCOS (RPI Program)

RCOS program (RPI student program) also uses a 3 slide template for each project

1. What the project is about
 - maintainers and the Github / URL for the project
- 2) Project Ideas
 - Ideally mapped to different skill levels
- 3) Contact Information

Project Ideas

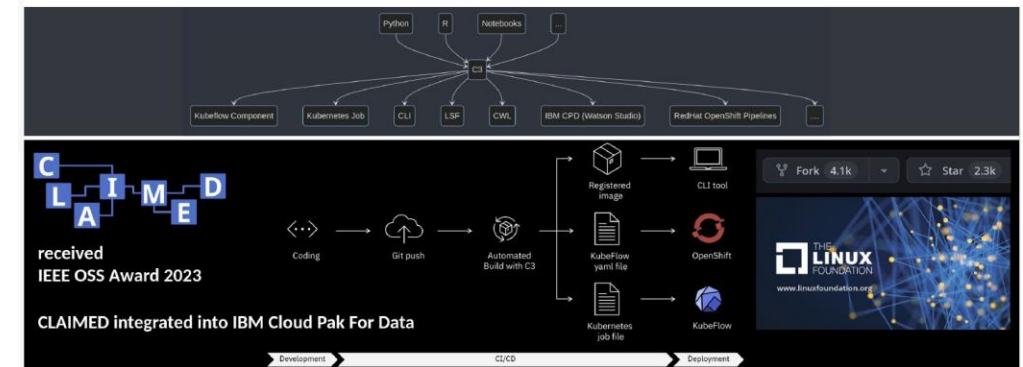
- Behavioral similarity search using graph embeddings [skills: Python, Go, Vector Databases, ML]
- Add Yara or KQL rules interpreter to SysFlow [skills: Go, detection engineering]
- Explainer for SysFlow traces/graphs (given a trace, summarize attack TTPs and kill chains in English) [skills: Python, ML, Linux]
- Help develop tutorials using our data science APIs [skills: Python, ML, Data Visualization, Data Science]
- Become a documentation czar! [skills: Technical writing, Communication]



<https://github.com/sysflow-telemetry>

Watch our OSSNA'23 talk to learn more about SysFlow!

<https://youtu.be/v3yVtLwy5AA>



<https://github.com/claimed-framework>

Ping romeokienzler on discord or
romeo.kienzler1@ibm.com

The sky is the limit ... for you to work on Open Liberty

Novel Applications

Demo cloud-native Java technologies in a fun way

Liberty Space Rover



Liberty Bikes



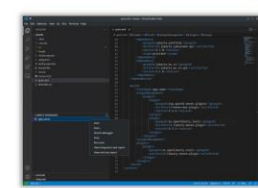
Samples & Guides

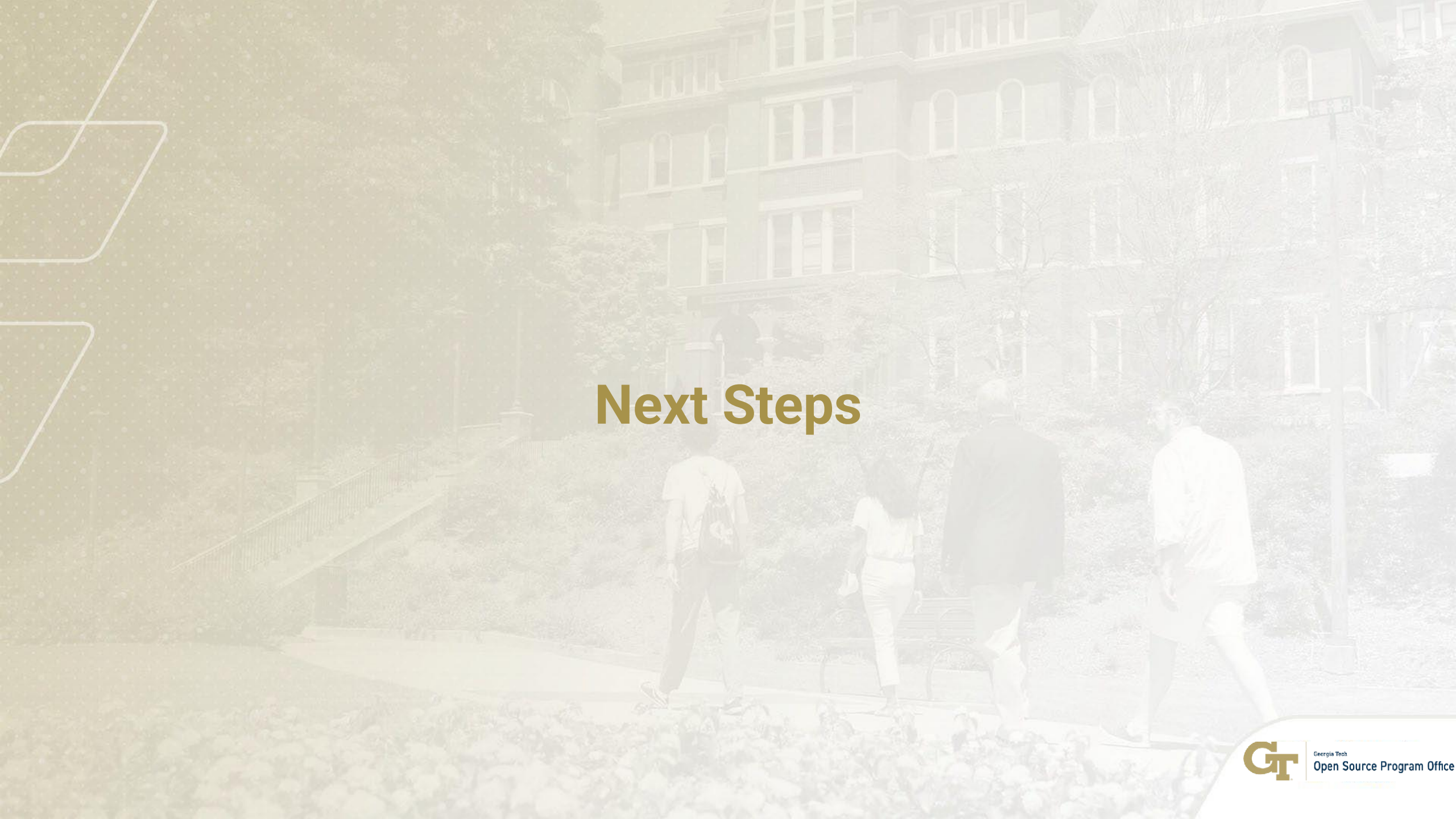
Create technical assets for developers to learn to build real-life applications



Liberty Components

Contribute to core components for the runtime and tools for developers





Next Steps



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Next Steps

Indicate your interest and willingness to mentor a project by filling out the project mentor application

GT Student Information Session: March 17th

- Plan to present your project with a 5 minute presentation and 3-4 slides maximum

VSIP Student Selection Process: Runs from March 18th to first week of April

VSIP program: Starts May 18th and runs until July 24th



[GT OSPO 2026 Virtual Summer Internship Program - Project Mentor Application](#)

Questions?

**Website: Use the contact form at
ospo.cc.gatech.edu**

